ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 4

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Punjabi Alphabet

ਮੇਰੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਪੰਜਾਬੀ ਵਰਣਮਾਲਾ

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 48 Punjabi Letters with English Phonetics

ਅ ਆ ਇ ਸ ਖ ਗ

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

My First Punjabi Alphabet — ਮੇਰੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਪੰਜਾਬੀ ਵਰਣਮਾਲਾ
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 4

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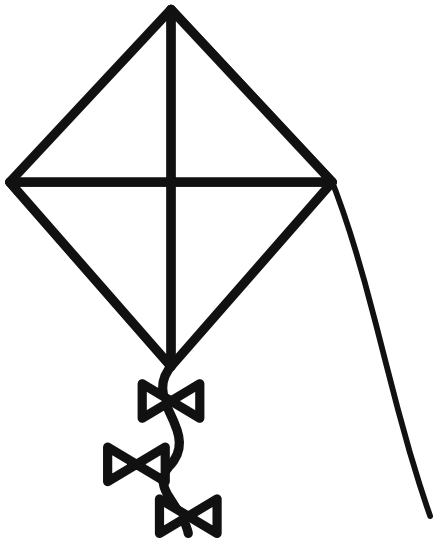
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Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

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A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

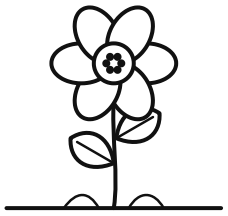


This book belongs to
ਇਹ ਕਿਤਾਬ ਮੇਰੀ ਹੈ

I started learning Punjabi on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 4 is Punjabi. More languages of the subcontinent are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **Doubled vowels are long:** *aa* as in "father", *ee* as in "see", *oo* as in "moon".
- **h after a letter** (*kh, gh, th, dh, bh*) means "add a puff of breath" — hold a tissue in front of your mouth and watch it move! It never means the English "th" of "the".
- **a** is the short sound in "about". Every consonant carries it: ਕ = *ka*.
- **Hard and soft t / d:** for the hard ones (ਟ ਠ ਡ) curl the tongue back; for the soft ones (ਤ ਥ ਦ) touch the back of your top teeth.
- **Tones:** ਘ ਝ ਢ ਧ ਭ are said with the voice dipping low. The English letters in this book show the sound (*kaṛee* for ਘੜੀ); the tone is best learned by listening.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Punjabi name** written in Punjabi (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Punjabi phonetics* shows how the sound is built the way Punjabi children learn it, for example ਕ੍ + ਅ = ਕ, or a vowel sign added to a consonant.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow standard Punjabi as spoken in Punjab.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Punjabi! ਪੰਜਾਬੀ

panjaabee — the Punjabi word for the language

Who speaks it?
More than **100 million people** speak Punjabi, in Pakistan, India and all over the world.[3]

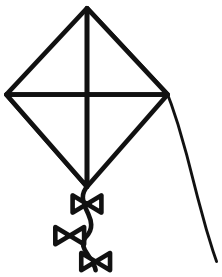
Where?
In the **Punjab** — the "land of five rivers" — which is shared by **Pakistan** and **India**, and in big communities in the UK, Canada and beyond.

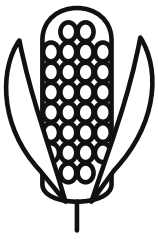
Two scripts
In India Punjabi is written in **Gurmukhi** (this book). In Pakistan it is written in **Shahmukhi**, a right-to-left script very like Urdu.

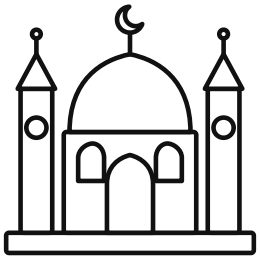
How is it written?
Gurmukhi is written from **left to right**, and letters hang from a line along the top.

How many letters?
This book teaches **48**: 10 vowels, the 32 traditional consonants and 6 letters with a dot.

Did you know?
Punjab's five rivers are the Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Beas and Sutlej — its name comes from Persian *panj* (five) + *aab* (water).







The Punjabi Alphabet ਵਰਣਮਾਲਾ

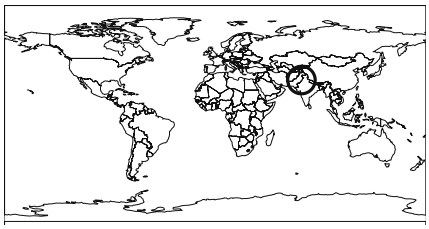
10 vowels — ਸੂਰ

ਅ *a*	ਆ *aa*	ਇ *i*	ਈ *ee*	ਉ *u*	ਊ *oo*	ਏ *e*
ਐ *ai*	ਓ *o*	ਔ *au*				

38 consonants — ਵਿਅੰਜਨ

ਸ *sassaa*	ਹ *haahaa*	ਕ *kakkaa*	ਖ *khakhkhaa*	ਗ *gaggaa*	ਘ *ghaggaa*	ਙ *ungaa*
ਚ *chachchaa*	ਛ *chhachchhaa*	ਜ *jajjaa*	ਝ *jhajjaa*	ਞ *njanjaa*	ਟ *ṭainkaa*	ਠ *ṭhaṭṭhaa*
ਡ *ḍaḍḍaa*	ਢ *ḍhaḍḍaa*	ਣ *ṇaaṇaa*	ਤ *tattaa*	ਥ *thatthaa*	ਦ *daddaa*	ਧ *dhaddaa*
ਨ *nannaa*	ਪ *pappaa*	ਫ *phaphphaa*	ਬ *babbaa*	ਭ *bhabbaa*	ਮ *mammaa*	ਯ *yayyaa*
ਰ *raaraa*	ਲ *lallaa*	ਵ *vaavaa*	ੜ *ṛaaṛaa*	ਸ਼ *sasse pair bindee*	ਖ਼ *khakhkhe pair bindee*	ਗ਼ *gagge pair bindee*
ਜ਼ *jajje pair bindee*	ਫ਼ *phaphphe pair bindee*	ਲ਼ *lalle pair bindee*				

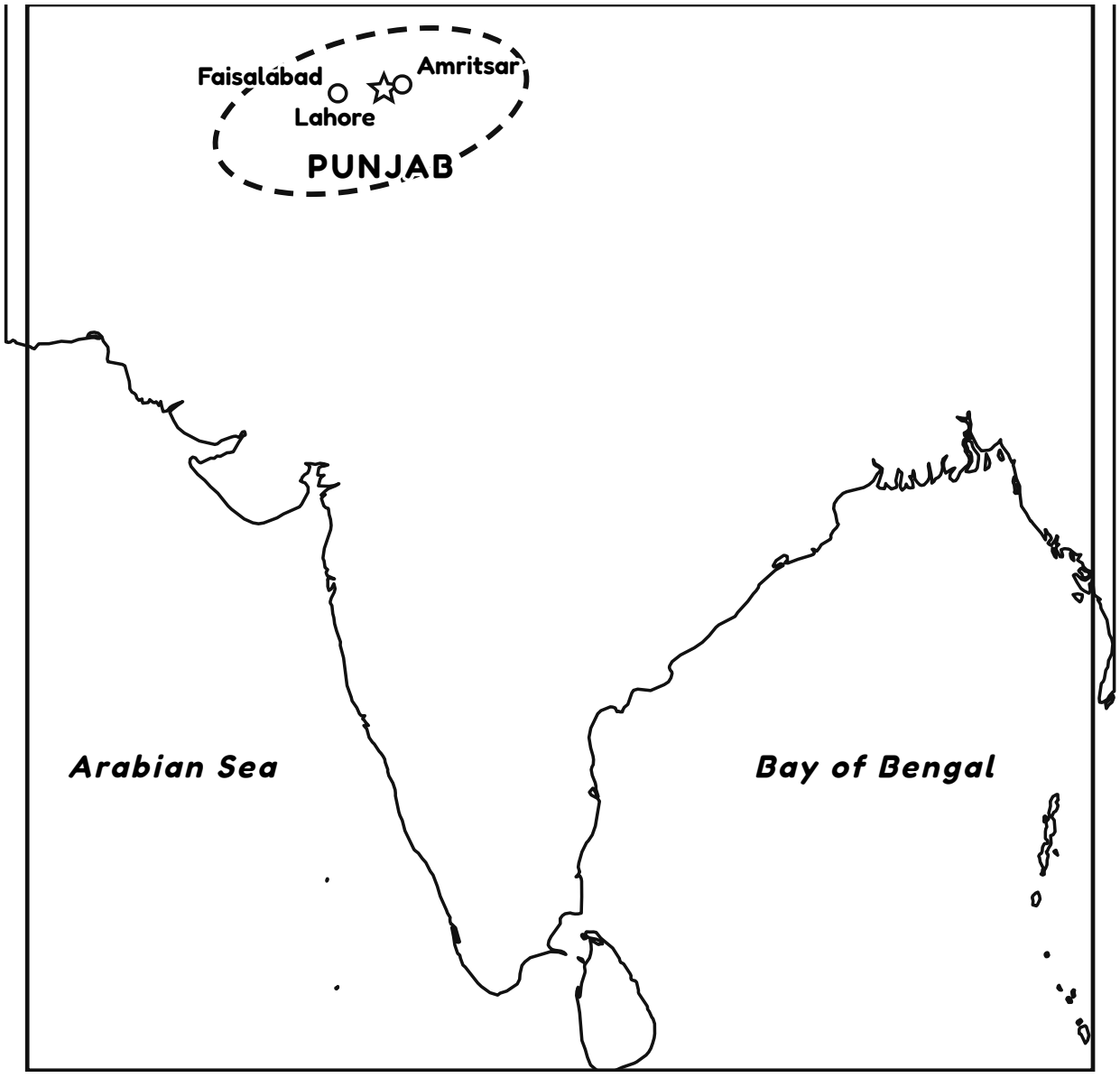
Read the alphabet left to right, row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows the Punjab on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Punjabi spoken?



Color it: the Punjab (inside the dashed line) **yellow** · the rest of the land **green** · the seas **blue**.
Find it: the Punjab is shared by Pakistan (Lahore ★, Faisalabad) and India (Amritsar). Draw five wavy blue rivers across it!

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PART 1

The Vowels ਸ੍ਵਰ

svar — “voice letters”

Vowels are the sounds you make with your mouth open: *a*, *aa*, *i*, *ee*, *u*, *oo*… This book has **10 vowels**.

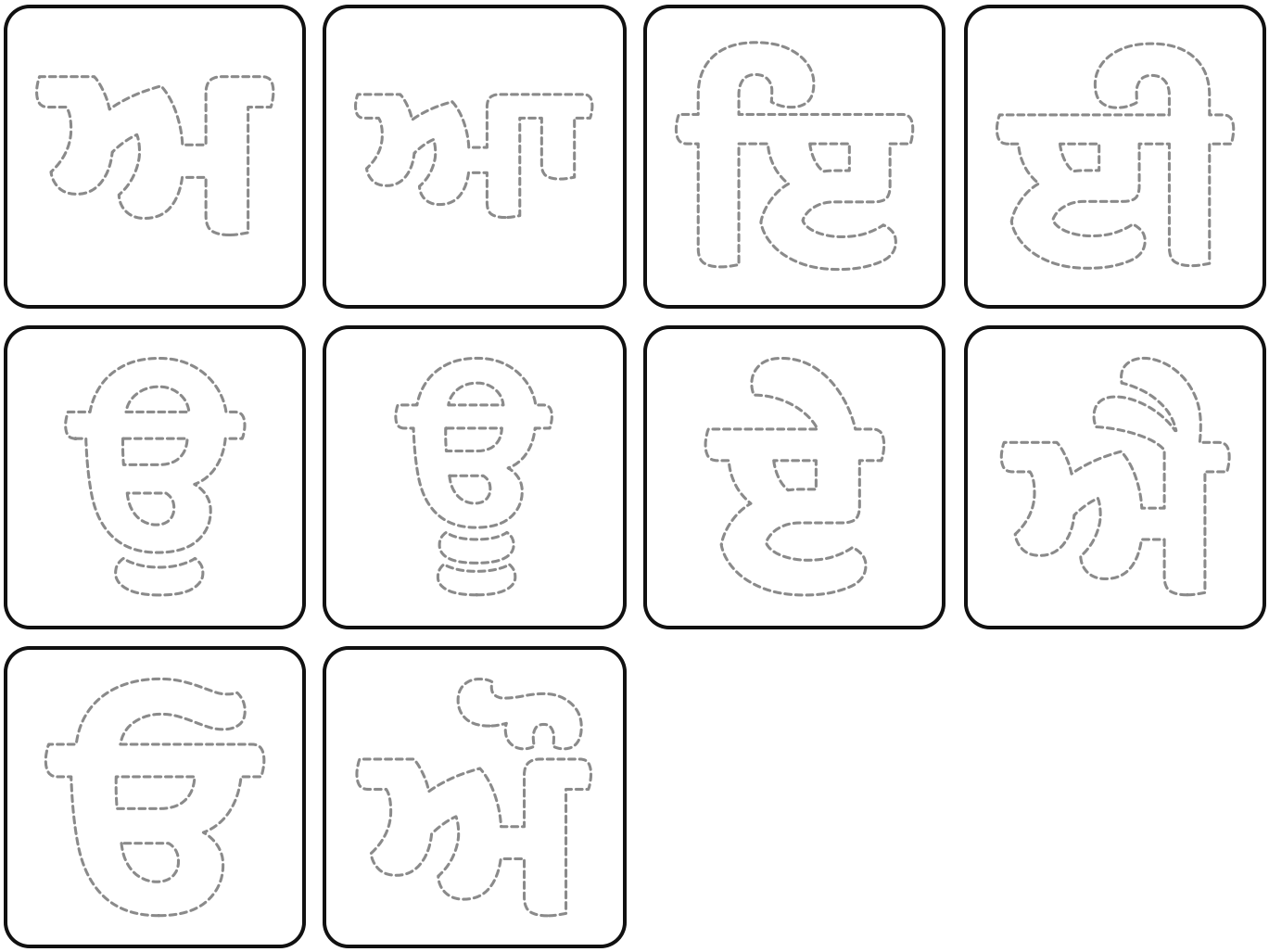
A vowel has **two shapes**. At the start of a word it is a full letter. After a consonant it becomes a small **vowel sign** that holds on to the consonant: ਕ + ◌ਾ = ਕਾ. In Gurmukhi every vowel is built on one of three **vowel carriers**: ੳ ਅ ੲ.

Vowel	Name	Sign	With ਕ
ਅ	*a*	—	ਕ
ਆ	*aa*	◌ਾ	ਕਾ
ਇ	*i*	◌ਿ	ਕਿ
ਈ	*ee*	◌ੀ	ਕੀ
ਉ	*u*	◌ੁ	ਕੁ
ਊ	*oo*	◌ੂ	ਕੂ
ਏ	*e*	◌ੇ	ਕੇ
ਐ	*ai*	◌ੈ	ਕੈ
ਓ	*o*	◌ੋ	ਕੋ
ਔ	*au*	◌ੌ	ਕੌ

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the vowels ਸ੍ਵ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



ਅ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਅ (ਐੜਾ)

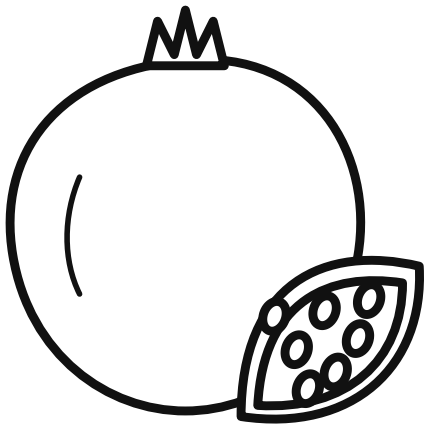
a

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a short ‘a’ as in “about”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

No sign! ਅ hides inside every consonant: ਕ = ਕ੍ + ਅ



ਅ IS FOR

ਅਨਾਰ

anaar

pomegranate

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਅ ਅ ਅ ਅ

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ਆ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਆ

aa

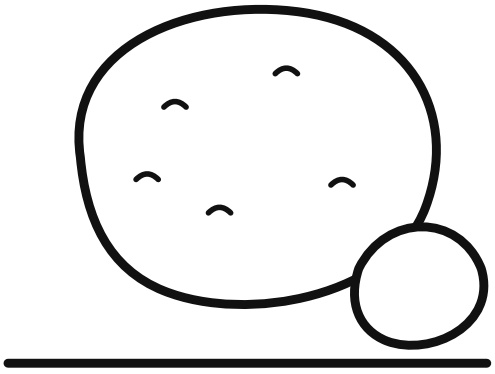
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'aa' as in "father"

PUNJABI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ਾ (ਕੰਨਾ)

ਕ + ਾ = ਕਾ



ਆ IS FOR

ਆਲੂ

aaloo

potato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਆ ਆ ਆ ਆ

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ਇ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਇ

i

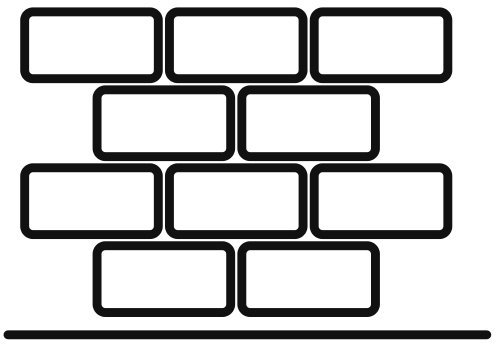
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘i’ as in “sit” — short

PUNJABI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ਿ (ਸਿਹਾਰੀ)

ਕ + ਿ = ਕਿ



ਇ IS FOR

ਇੱਟ

itt

brick

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਇ ਇ ਇ ਇ

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ਈ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਈ

ee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ee' as in "see" — long

PUNJABI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ੀ (ਬਿਹਾਰੀ)

ਕ + ੀ = ਕੀ



ਈ IS FOR

ਈਦ

eed

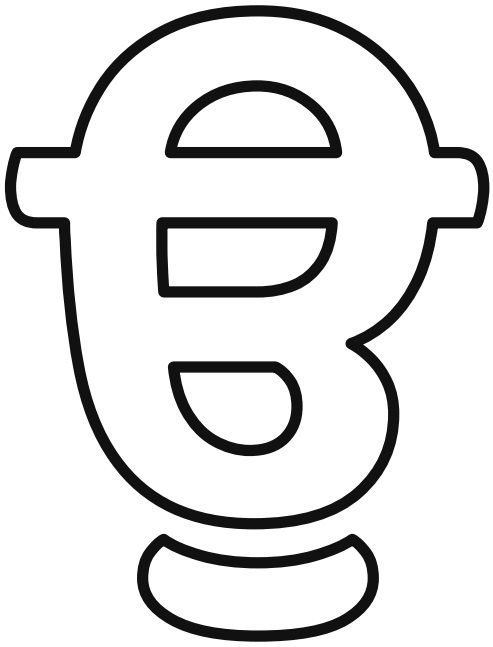
Eid, the festival day

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

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NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਉ

u

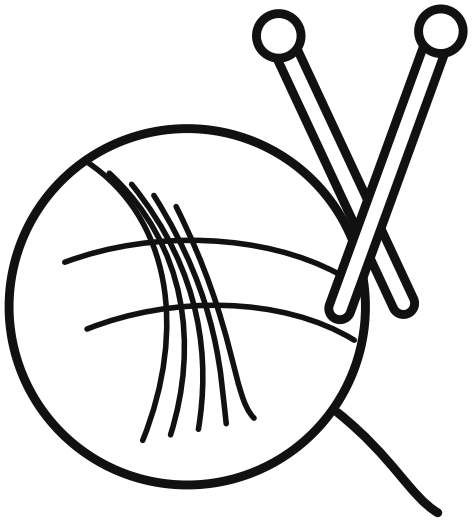
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘u’ as in “put” — short

PUNJABI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ੁ (ਔਂਕੜ)

ਕ + ੁ = ਕੁ



ਉ IS FOR

ਉੱਨ

unn

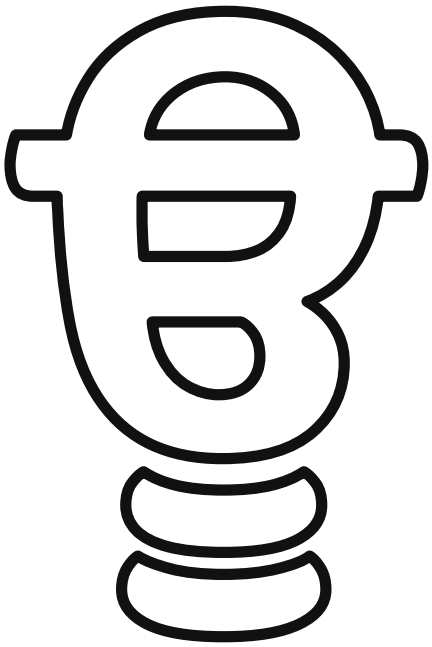
wool

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

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NAME · ਨਾਂ

ੳ

oo

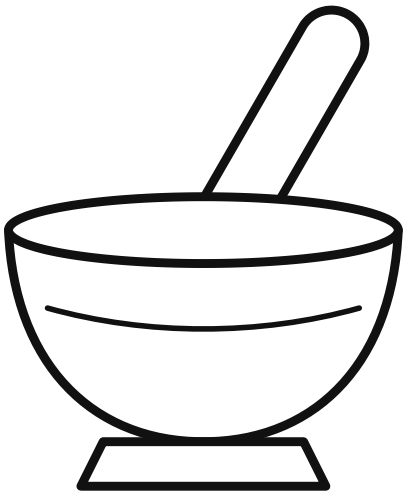
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘oo’ as in “moon” — long

PUNJABI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ੁ (ਦੁਲੈਂਕੜ)

ਕ + ੁ = ਕੁ



ੳ IS FOR

ਉਖਲ

ookhal

mortar (for grinding spices)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ੳ ੳ ੳ ੳ

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ੲੇ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ੲੇ

e

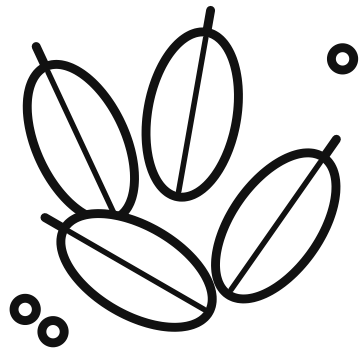
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘e’ as in “they” (say “ay”)

PUNJABI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ੇ (ਲਾਂ)

ਕ + ੇ = ਕੇ



ੲੇ IS FOR

ਏਲਚੀ

elchee

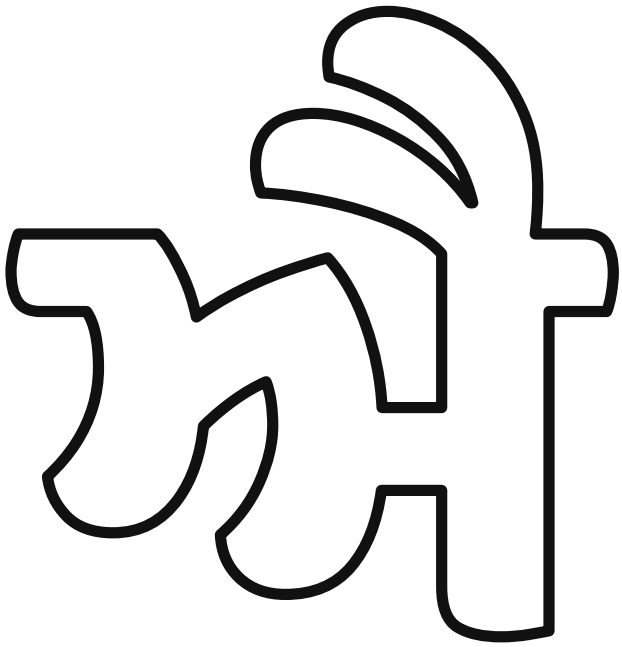
cardamom

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ੲੇ ੲੇ ੲੇ ੲੇ

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NAME · ਨਾਂ

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ai

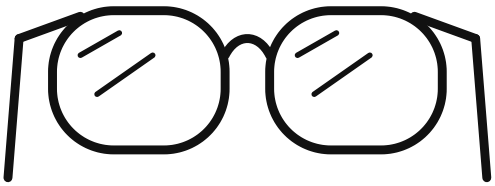
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ai’ — like the ‘a’ in “bat”, said long

PUNJABI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ੈ (ਦੁਲਾਵਾਂ)

ਕ + ੈ = ਕੈ



ਐ IS FOR

ਐਨਕ

ainak

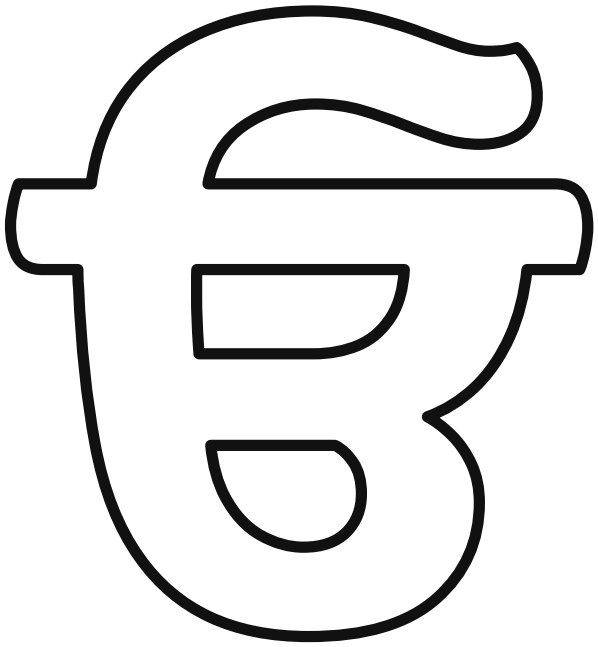
glasses

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

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NAME · ਨਾਂ

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o

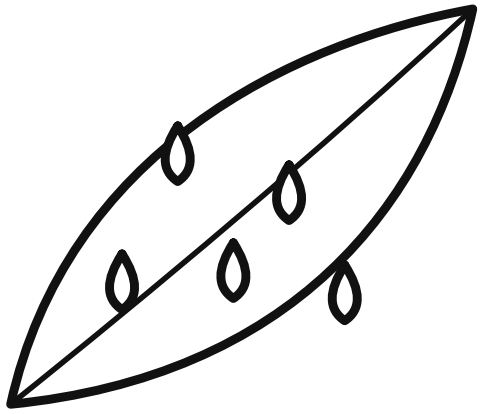
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’ as in “go”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ੋ (ਹੋੜਾ)

ਕ + ੋ = ਕੋ



ਓ IS FOR

ਓਸ

os

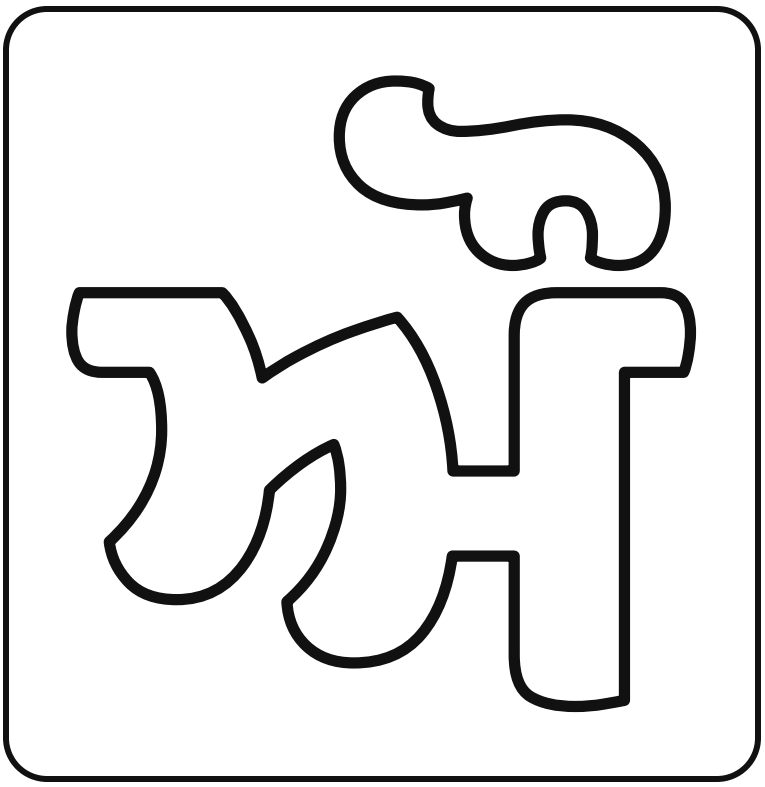
dew

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

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NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਔ

au

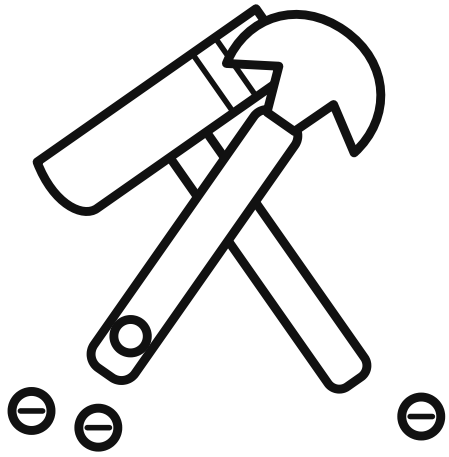
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘au’ — like the ‘aw’ in “saw”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ੌ (ਕਨੌੜਾ)

ਕ + ੌ = ਕੌ



ਔ IS FOR

ਔਜ਼ਾਰ

auzaar

tools

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਔ ਔ ਔ ਔ

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PART 2

The Consonants ਵਿਅੰਜਨ

viyanjan

Consonants are the sounds made by stopping or squeezing the air: *k*, *g*, *ch*, *j*, *t*, *d*, *p*, *b*... This book has **38 consonants**. That is the 32 consonants of the traditional alphabet (ਪੈਂਤੀ *paintee*, "the thirty-five") and 6 letters with a dot at the foot (ਪੈਰ ਬਿੰਦੀ *pair bindee*) for sounds borrowed from Persian and Arabic.

The hidden vowel

Every consonant secretly carries a short vowel *(a)*. That is why ਕ is said *ka*, not just *k*:

ਕ੍ + ਅ = ਕ

k + a = ka. In Gurmukhi the little mark ◌੍ (*halant*) is rarely written; joined letters are made with small signs at the foot of a letter instead.

Families of five

The first consonants come in families, each made in a different part of the mouth:

ਕ ਖ ਗ ਘ ਙ — back of the throat

ਚ ਛ ਜ ਝ ਞ — middle of the tongue

ਟ ਠ ਡ ਢ ਣ — tongue curled back (hard)

ਤ ਥ ਦ ਧ ਨ — tongue on the teeth (soft)

ਪ ਫ ਬ ਭ ਮ — the lips

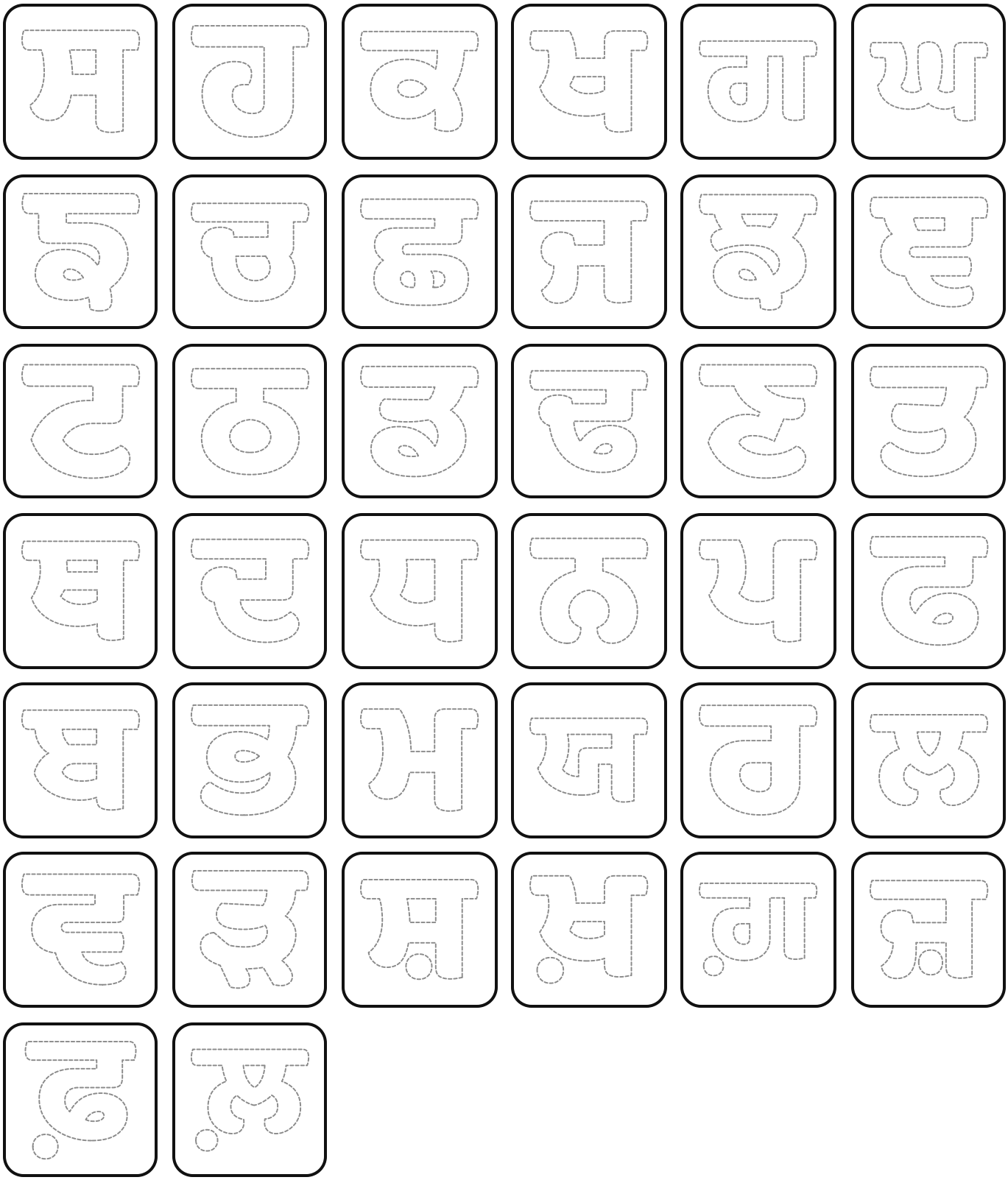
Punjabi has tones!

Punjabi is one of the few languages of South Asia with **tones**. ਘ ਝ ਢ ਧ ਭ are not said with a puff: at the start of a word they sound like *k*, *ch*, *ṭ*, *t*, *p* with the voice dipping low. Listen to a Punjabi speaker and copy the tune!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the consonants ਵਿਅੰਜਨ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



ਸ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਸ (ਸੱਸਾ)

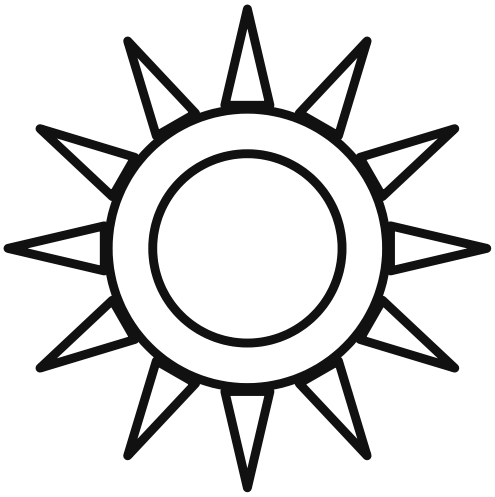
sassaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਸ੍ + ਅ = ਸ



ਸ IS FOR

ਸੂਰਜ

sooraj

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਸ ਸ ਸ ਸ

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ਹ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਹ (ਹਾਹਾ)

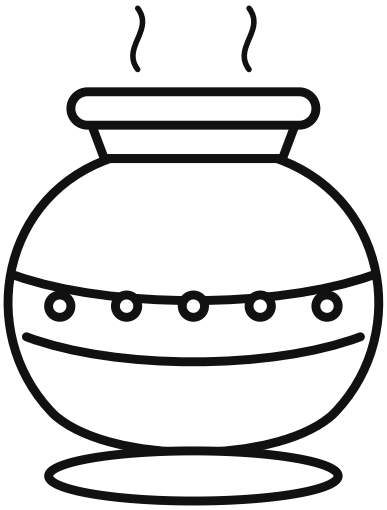
haahaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਹ੍ + ਅ = ਹ



ਹ IS FOR

ਹਾਂਡੀ

haandee

clay pot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਹ ਹ ਹ ਹ

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ਕ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਕ (ਕੱਕਾ)

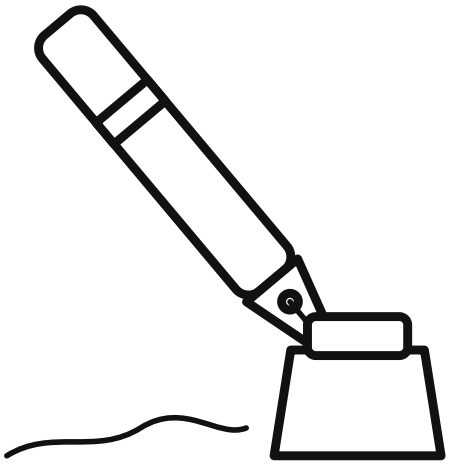
kakkaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'k' as in "kite"

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਕ੍ + ਅ = ਕ



ਕ IS FOR

ਕਲਮ

kalam

pen

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਕ ਕ ਕ ਕ

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ਖ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਖ (ਖੱਖਾ)

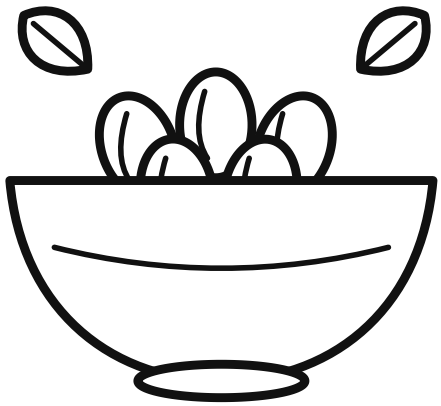
khakhkhaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'k' with a puff of air

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਖ੍ + ਅ = ਖ



ਖ IS FOR

ਖਜੂਰ

khajoor

dates

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਖ ਖ ਖ ਖ

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ਗ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਗ (ਗੱਗਾ)

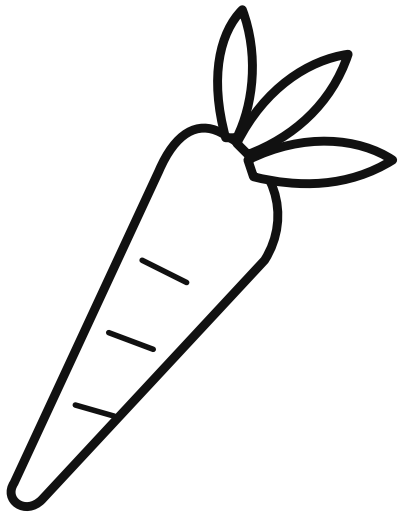
gaggaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਗ੍ + ਅ = ਗ



ਗ IS FOR

ਗਾਜਰ

gaajar

carrot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਗਾ ਗਾ ਗਾ ਗਾ

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ਘ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਘ (ਘੱਗਾ)

ghaggaa

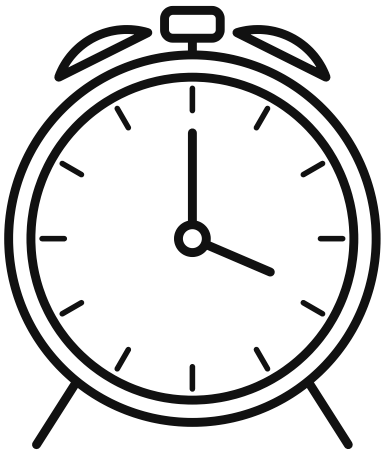
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ with a low tone (see the note)

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਘ੍ + ਅ = ਘ

In Punjabi this letter carries a *tone*: at the start of a word it sounds like ‘k’ said with the voice dipping low.



ਘ IS FOR

ਘੜੀ

kaṛee

clock

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਘ ਘ ਘ ਘ

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ਙ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਙ (ਙੰਙਾ)

ungaa

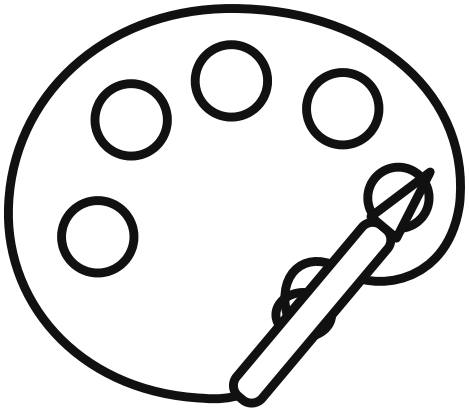
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ng’ as in “sing” — a rare letter

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਙ੍ + ਅ = ਙ

ਙ is almost never written today: the ‘ng’ in ਰੰਗ uses the sign ◌ੰ.



ਙ IS FOR

ਰੰਗ

rang

colour

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਙ ਙ ਙ ਙ

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ਚ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਚ (ਚੱਚਾ)

chachchaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਚ੍ + ਅ = ਚ



ਚ IS FOR

ਚੰਨ

chann

moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਚ ਚ ਚ ਚ

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ਛ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਛ (ਛੱਛਾ)

chhachchhaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ with a puff of air

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਛ੍ + ਅ = ਛ



ਛ IS FOR

ਛੱਤਰੀ

chhattree

umbrella

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਛ ਛ ਛ ਛ

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ਜ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਜ (ਜੱਜਾ)

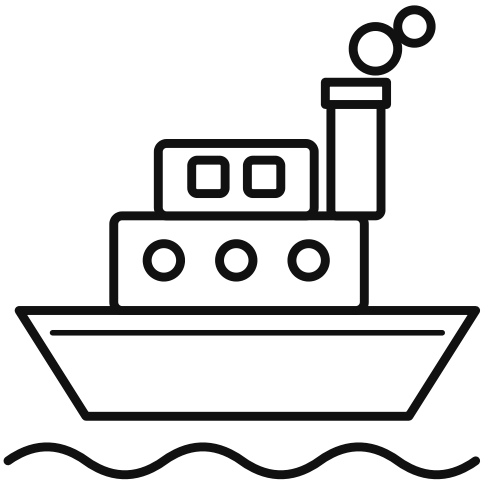
jajjaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'j' as in "jam"

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਜ੍ + ਅ = ਜ



ਜ IS FOR

ਜਹਾਜ਼

jahaaz

ship

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਜ ਜ ਜ ਜ

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ਝ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਝ (ਝੱਜਾ)

jhajjaa

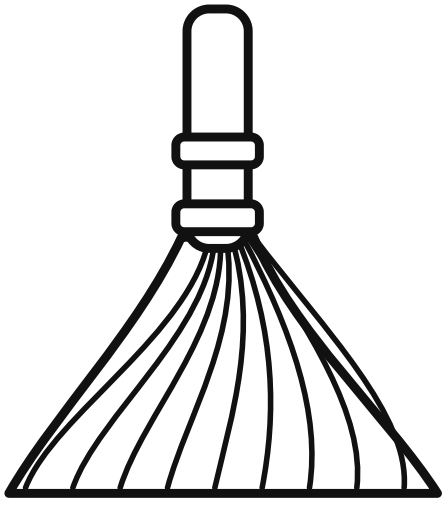
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ with a low tone (see the note)

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਝ੍ + ਅ = ਝ

In Punjabi this letter carries a *tone*: at the start of a word it sounds like ‘ch’ said with the voice dipping low.



ਝ IS FOR

ਛਾੜੂ

chaaṛoo

broom

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਝ ਝ ਝ ਝ

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ਞ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਞ (ਞੰਞਾ)

njanjaa

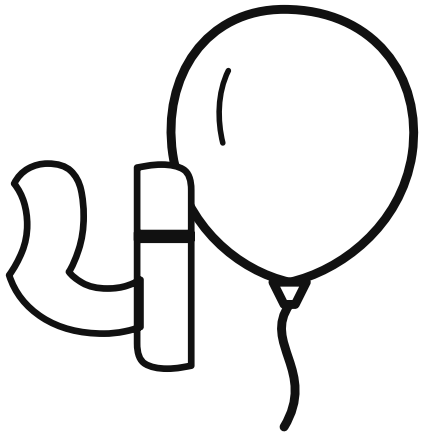
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘n’ near the roof of the mouth — a rare letter

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਞ੍ + ਅ = ਞ

ਞ is almost never written today: the ‘nj’ in ਪੰਜ uses ◌ੰ.



ਞ IS FOR

ਪੰਜ

panj

five

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਞ ਞ ਞ ਞ

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ਟ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਟ (ਟੈਂਕਾ)

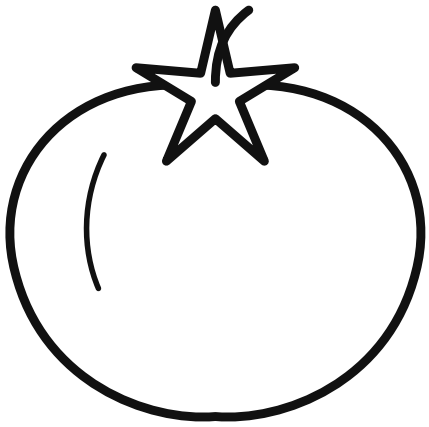
ṭainkaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘t’ — curl your tongue back, as in “top”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਟ੍ + ਅ = ਟ



ਟ IS FOR

ਟਮਾਟਰ

ṭamaaṭar

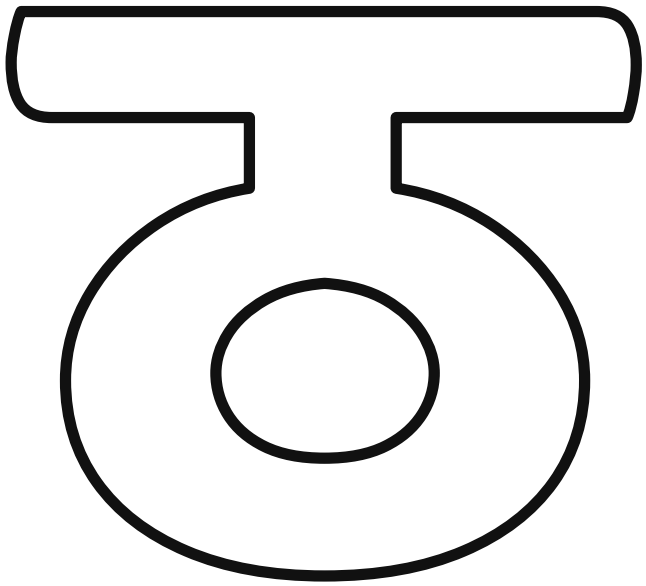
tomato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਟ ਟ ਟ ਟ

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NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਠ (ਠੱਠਾ)

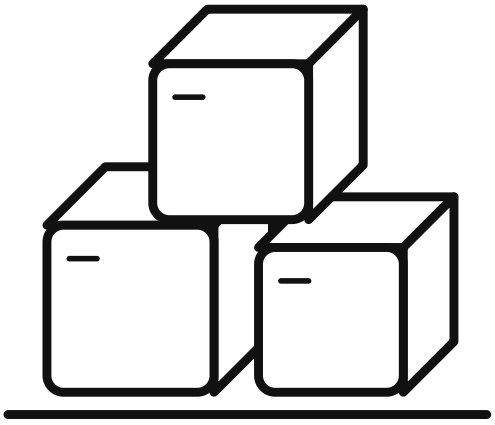
ṭhaṭṭhaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘t’ with a puff of air

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਠ੍ + ਅ = ਠ



ਠ IS FOR

ਠੰਢ

ṭhandh

cold

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਠ ਠ ਠ ਠ

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ਡ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਡ (ਡੱਡਾ)

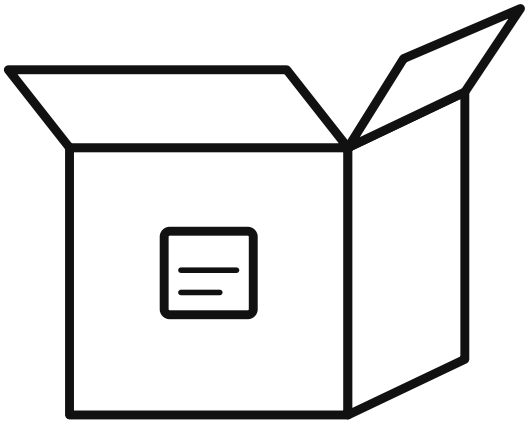
ḍaḍḍaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘d’ — curl your tongue back, as in “dog”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ੜ੍ + ਅ = ਡ



ਡ IS FOR

ਡੱਬਾ

ḍabbaa

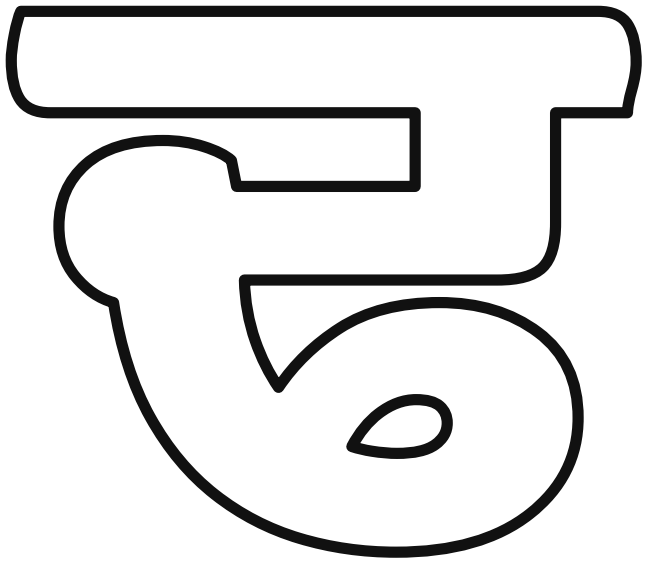
box

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਡ ਡ ਡ ਡ

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NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਢ (ਢੱਡਾ)

ḍhaḍḍaa

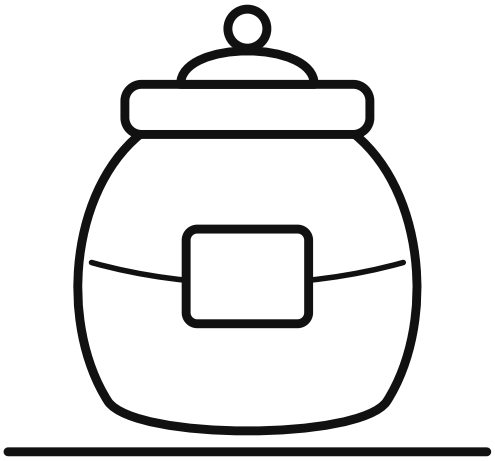
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘ṭ’ with a low tone (see the note)

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਢ੍ + ਅ = ਢ

In Punjabi this letter carries a *tone*: at the start of a word it sounds like ‘ṭ’ said with the voice dipping low.



ਢ IS FOR

ਢੱਕਣ

ṭakkaṇ

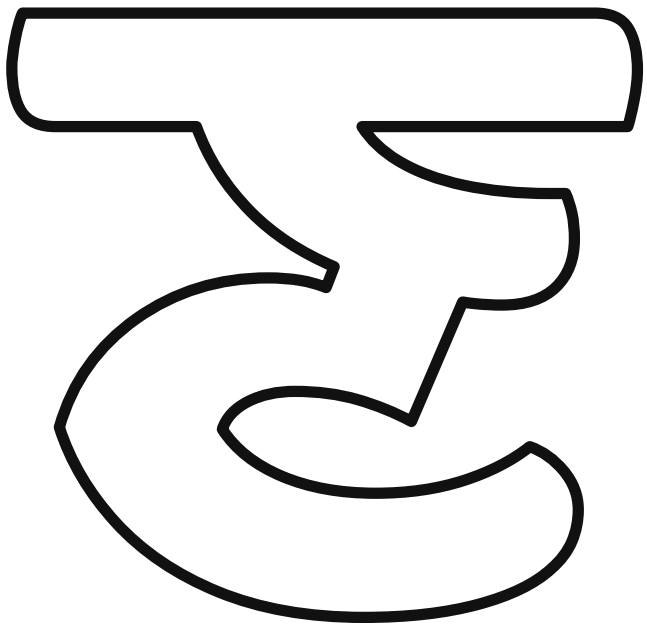
lid

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਢ ਢ ਢ ਢ

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NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਣ (ਣਾਣਾ)

ṇaaṇaa

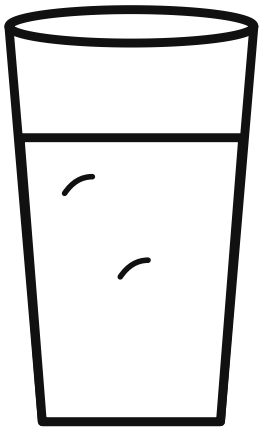
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ with the tongue curled back — never at the start of a word

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਣ੍ + ਅ = ਣ

Find ਣ in the middle of ਪਾਣੀ!



ਣ IS FOR

ਪਾਣੀ

paaṇee

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਣ ਣ ਣ ਣ

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ਤ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਤ (ਤੱਤਾ)

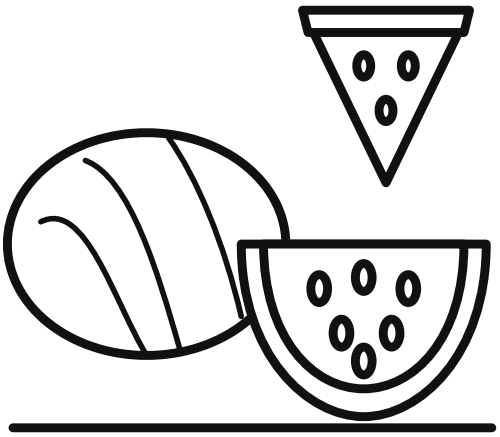
tattaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘t’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ੂ + ਅ = ਤ



ਤ IS FOR

ਤਰਬੂਜ਼

tarbooz

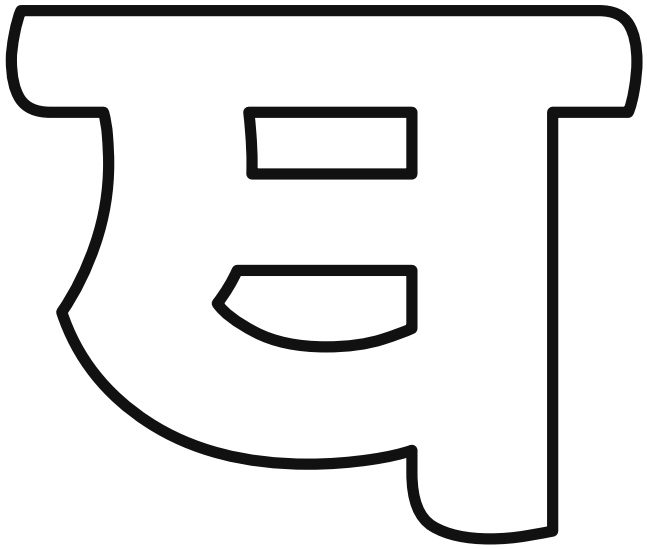
watermelon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਤ ਤ ਤ ਤ

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NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਥ (ਥੱਥਾ)

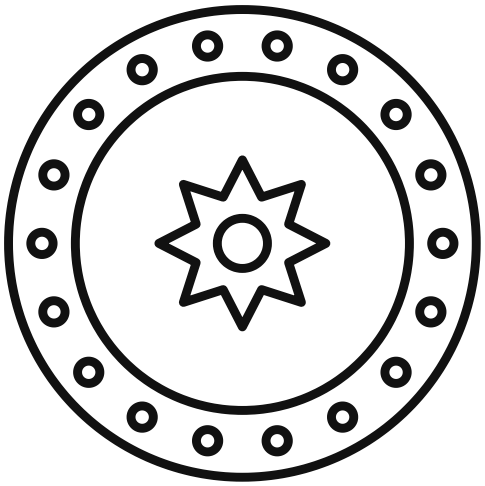
thatthaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘t’ with a puff of air

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਥ੍ + ਅ = ਥ



ਥ IS FOR

ਥਾਲੀ

thaalee

plate

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਥ ਥ ਥ ਥ

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ਦ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਦ (ਦੱਦਾ)

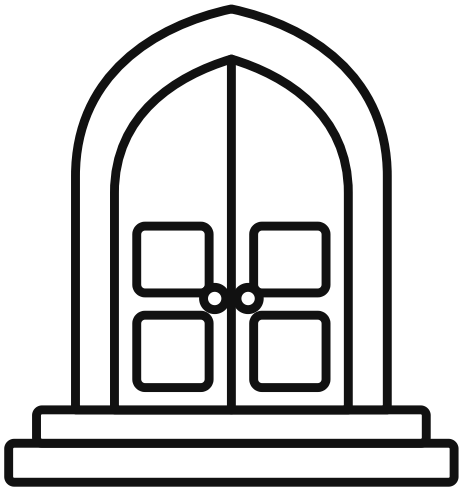
daddaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘d’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਦ੍ + ਅ = ਦ



ਦ IS FOR

ਦਰਵਾਜ਼ਾ

darvaazaa

door

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਦ ਦ ਦ ਦ

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ਧ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਧ (ਧੱਦਾ)

dhaddaa

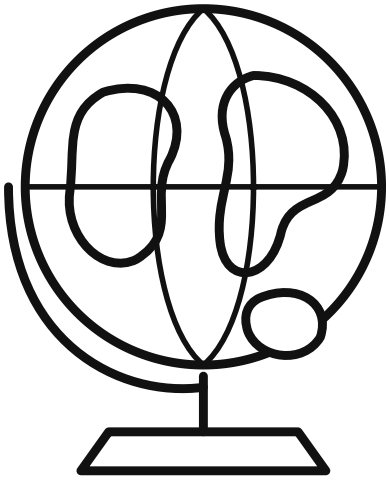
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘t’ with a low tone (see the note)

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਧ੍ + ਅ = ਧ

In Punjabi this letter carries a *tone*: at the start of a word it sounds like ‘t’ said with the voice dipping low.



ਧ IS FOR

ਧਰਤੀ

tartee

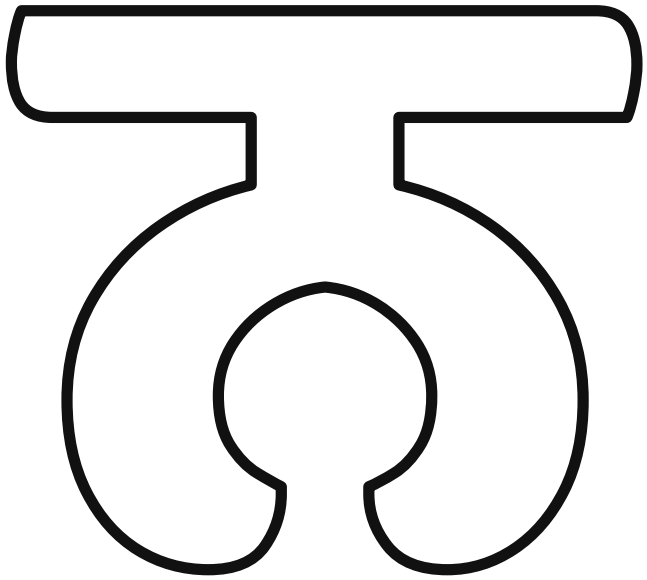
the Earth

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਧ ਧ ਧ ਧ

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NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਨ (ਨੱਨਾ)

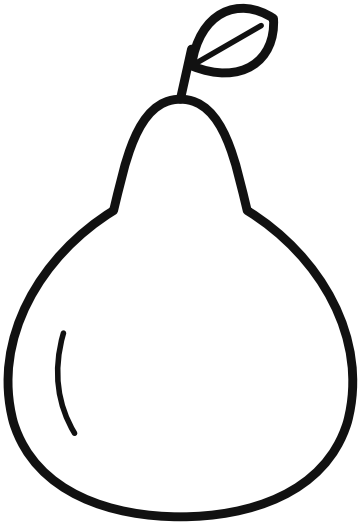
nannaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਨ੍ + ਅ = ਨ



ਨ IS FOR

ਨਾਸ਼ਪਾਤੀ

naashpaatee

pear

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਨ ਨ ਨ ਨ

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ਪ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਪ (ਪੱਪਾ)

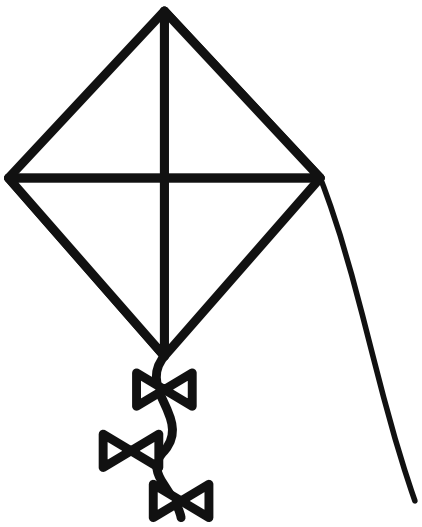
pappaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ as in “pen”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਪ੍ + ਅ = ਪ



ਪ IS FOR

ਪਤੰਗ

patang

kite

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਪ ਪ ਪ ਪ

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ਢ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਢ (ਫੱਫਾ)

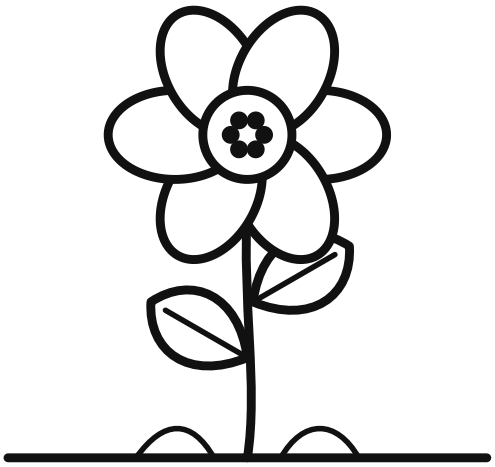
phaphphaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ with a puff of air

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਫ੍ + ਅ = ਢ



ਢ IS FOR

ਫੁੱਲ

phull

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਢ ਢ ਢ ਢ

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ਬ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਬ (ਬੱਬਾ)

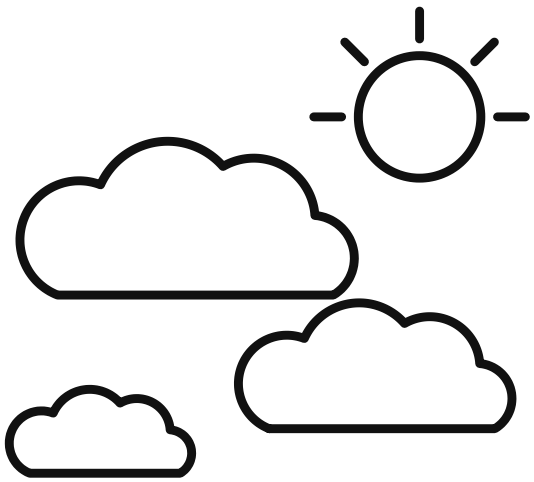
babbaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਬ੍ + ਅ = ਬ



ਬ IS FOR

ਬੱਦਲ

baddal

clouds

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਬ ਬ ਬ ਬ

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ਭ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਭ (ਭੱਬਾ)

bhabbaa

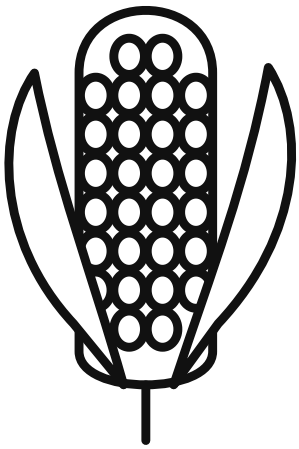
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ with a low tone (see the note)

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਭ੍ + ਅ = ਭ

In Punjabi this letter carries a *tone*: at the start of a word it sounds like ‘p’ said with the voice dipping low.



ਭ IS FOR

ਭੁੱਟਾ

puttaa

corn cob

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਭ ਭ ਭ ਭ

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ਮ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਮ (ਮੱਮਾ)

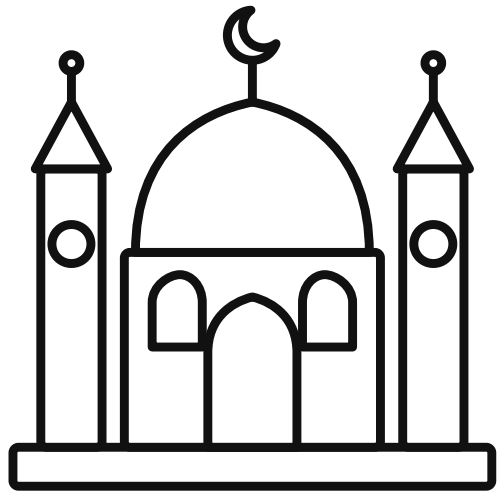
mammaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਮ੍ + ਅ = ਮ



ਮ IS FOR

ਮਸਜਿਦ

masjid

mosque

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਮ ਮ ਮ ਮ

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ਯ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਯ (ਯੱਜਾ)

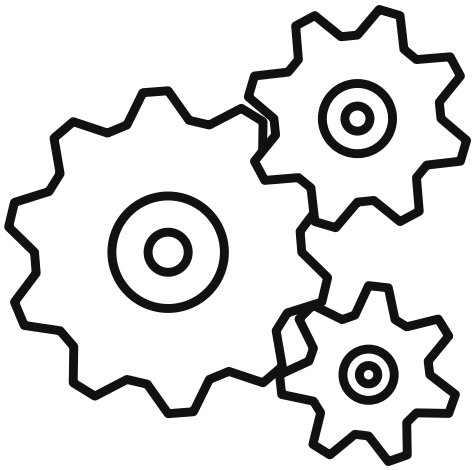
yayyaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਯ੍ + ਅ = ਯ



ਯ IS FOR

ਯੰਤਰ

yantar

machine

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਯ ਯ ਯ ਯ

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ਰ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਰ (ਰਾਰਾ)

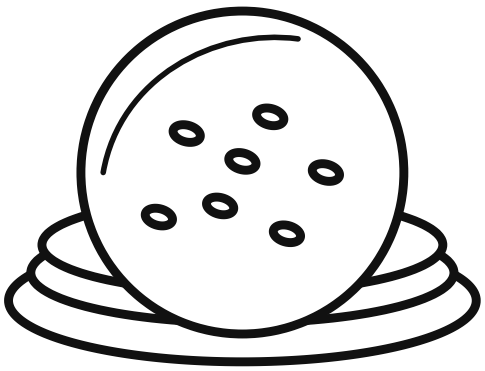
raaraa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a tapped ‘r’ — flick the tongue once

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਰ੍ + ਅ = ਰ



ਰ IS FOR

ਰੋਟੀ

roṭee

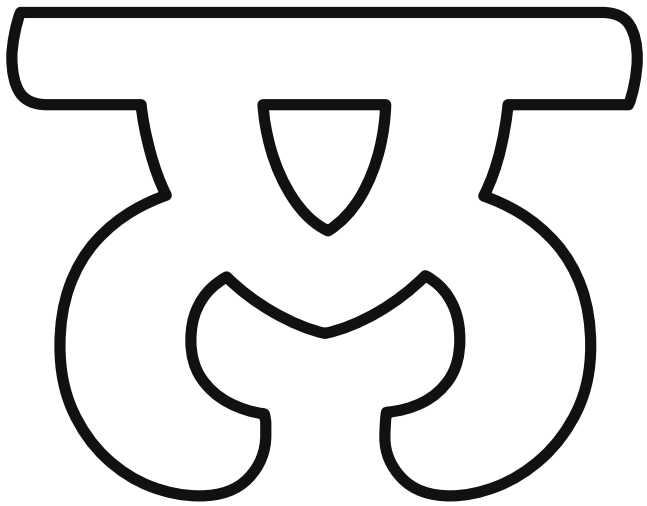
flatbread (roti)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਰ ਰ ਰ ਰ

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NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਲ (ਲੱਲਾ)

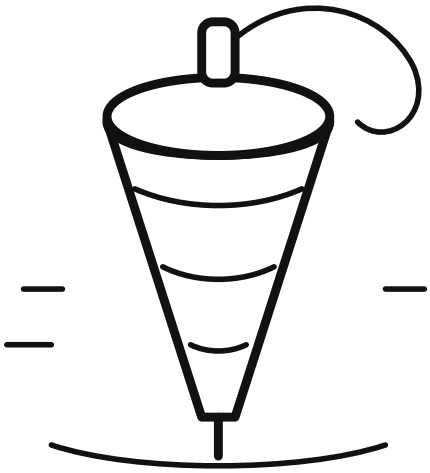
lallaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਲ੍ + ਅ = ਲ



ਲ IS FOR

ਲਾਟੂ

laaṭoo

spinning top

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਲ ਲ ਲ ਲ

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ੜ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ੜ (ਵਾਵਾ)

vaavaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

between ‘v’ and ‘w’

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ੜ੍ + ਅ = ੜ



ੜ IS FOR

ਵਰਖਾ

varkhaa

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ੜ ੜ ੜ ੜ

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ੜ

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ੜ (ੜਾੜਾ)

ṛaaṛaa

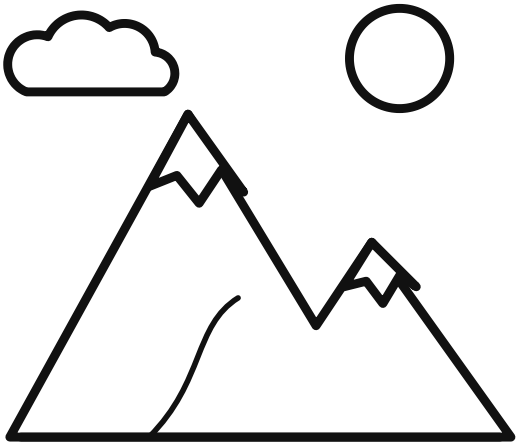
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a flapped ‘r’ with the tongue curled back — never at the start of a word

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ੜ੍ + ਅ = ੜ

Look for ੜ at the end of ਪਹਾੜ!



ੜ IS FOR

ਪਹਾੜ

pahaaṛ

mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ੜ ੜ ੜ ੜ

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ਸ਼

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਸ਼

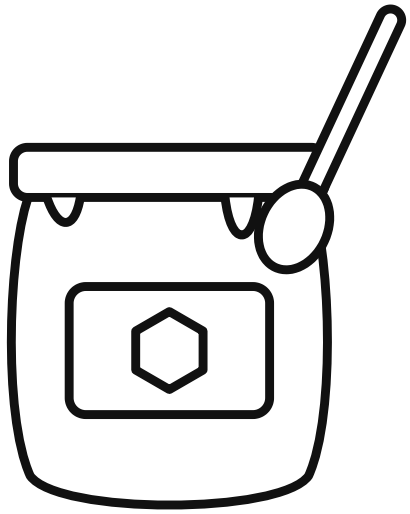
sasse pair bindee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'sh' as in "shoe"

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਸ + ◌਼ = ਸ਼



ਸ਼ IS FOR

ਸ਼ਹਿਦ

shahid

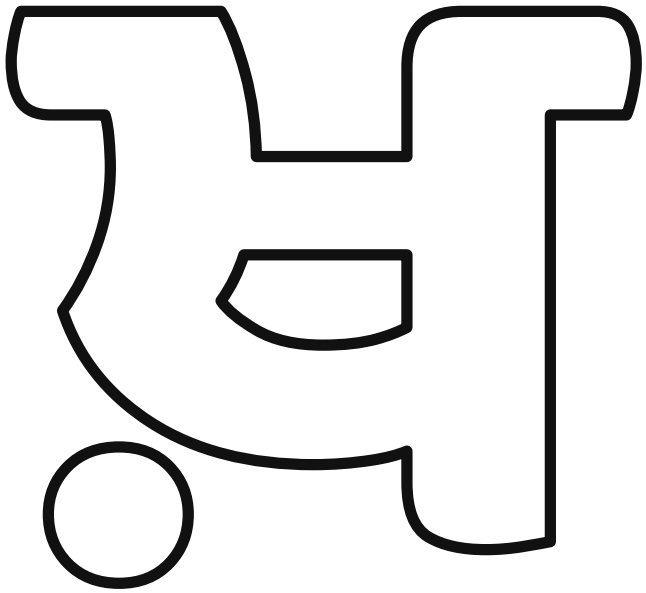
honey

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਸ਼ ਸ਼ ਸ਼ ਸ਼

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NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਖ਼

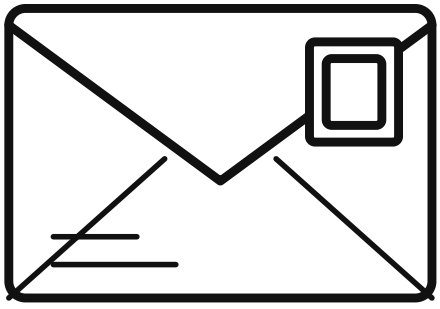
khakhkhe pair bindee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a scratchy ‘kh’ from the throat, as in Scottish “loch”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਖ + ◌਼ = ਖ਼



ਖ਼ IS FOR

ਖ਼ਤ

khat

letter (that you post)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਖ਼ ਖ਼ ਖ਼ ਖ਼

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ਗ਼

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਗ਼ਾ

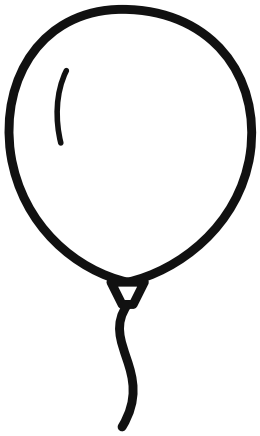
gagge pair bindee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft gargled ‘gh’ from the back of the throat

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਗ + ◌਼ = ਗ਼ਾ



ਗ਼ IS FOR

ਗ਼ੁਬਾਰਾ

ghubaaraa

balloon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਗ਼ਾ ਗ਼ਾ ਗ਼ਾ ਗ਼ਾ

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ਜ਼

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਜ਼

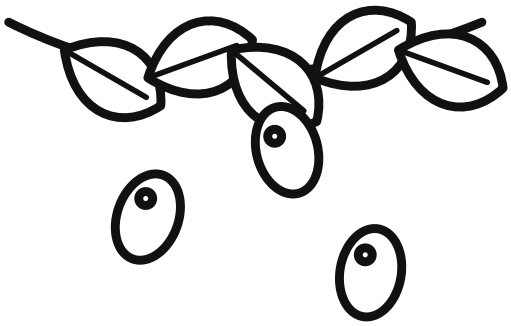
jajje pair bindee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘z’ as in “zoo”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਜ + ◌਼ = ਜ਼



ਜ਼ IS FOR

ਜ਼ੈਤੂਨ

zaitoon

olive

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਜ਼ ਜ਼ ਜ਼ ਜ਼

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ਫ਼

NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਫ਼

phaphphe pair bindee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਫ + ◌਼ = ਫ਼



ਫ਼ IS FOR

ਫ਼ਾਨੂਸ

faanoos

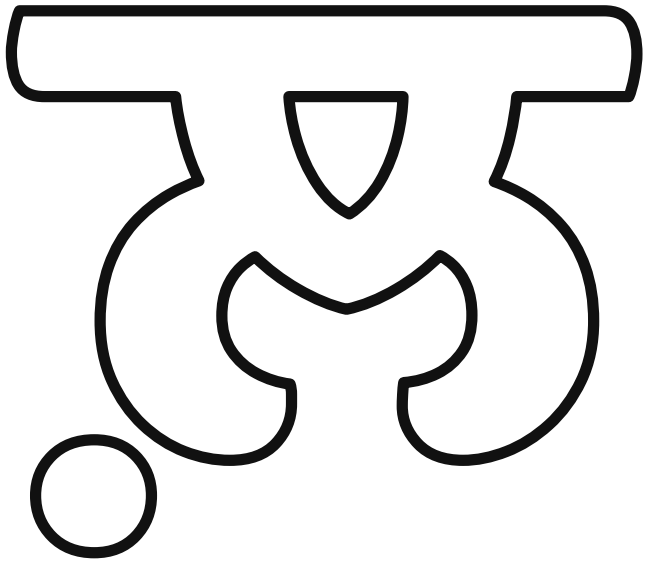
lantern

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

ਫ਼ ਫ਼ ਫ਼ ਫ਼

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NAME · ਨਾਂ

ਲ਼

lalle pair bindee

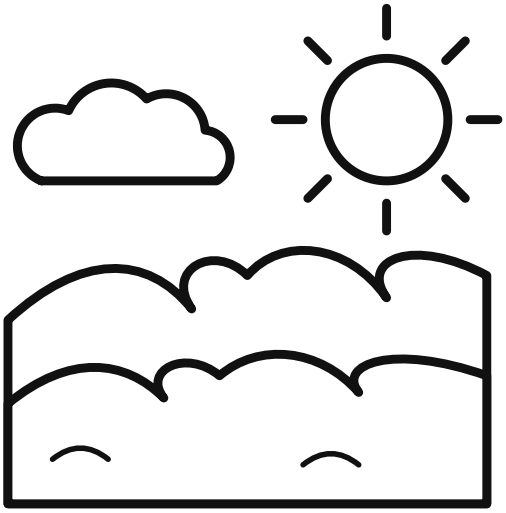
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

an ‘l’ with the tongue curled back — never at the start of a word

PUNJABI PHONETICS · HOW IT IS BUILT

ਲ + ◌਼ = ਲ਼

Find ਲ਼ in the middle of ਨੀਲ਼ਾ — color the sea blue!



ਲ਼ IS FOR

ਨੀਲ਼ਾ

neeḷaa

blue (like the sea)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

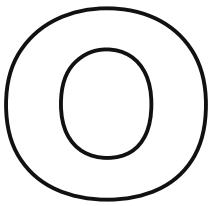
TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ਲਿਖੋ

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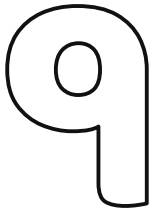
BONUS

Punjabi numbers ਅੰਕ *(ank)*

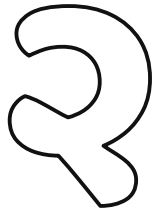
Color the numbers and count out loud in Punjabi: *sifar*, *ikk*, *do*, *tinn*...



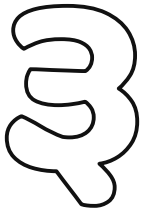
0
ਸਿਫ਼ਰ
sifar
zero



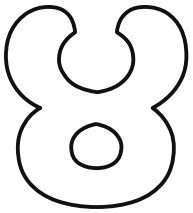
1
ਇੱਕ
ikk
one



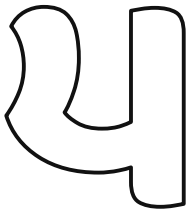
2
ਦੋ
do
two



3
ਤਿੰਨ
tinn
three



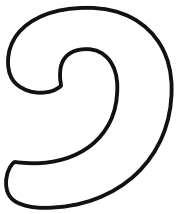
4
ਚਾਰ
chaar
four



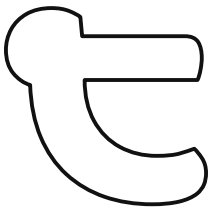
5
ਪੰਜ
panj
five



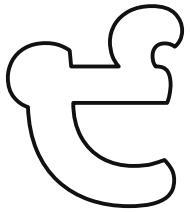
6
ਛੇ
chhe
six



7
ਸੱਤ
satt
seven



8
ਅੱਠ
aṭṭh
eight



9
ਨੌਂ
naun
nine

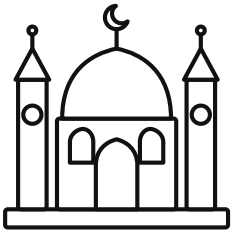
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LET'S TALK

My first Punjabi words ਪਹਿਲੇ ਸ਼ਬਦ

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

ਅੱਸਲਾਮੁ ਅਲੈਕੁਮ	*assalaamu alaikum* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
ਵ ਅਲੈਕੁਮ ਅੱਸਲਾਮ	*va alaikum assalaam* **And upon you be peace (the reply)**
ਮੇਰਾ ਨਾਂ ... ਹੈ	*meraa naan ... hai* **My name is ...**
ਸ਼ੁਕਰੀਆ	*shukreeaa* **Thank you**
ਜਜ਼ਾਕੱਲਾਹੁ ਖ਼ੈਰਨ	*jazaakallaahu khairan* **May Allah reward you with good**
ਮਾਂ · ਪਿਓ	*maan · pio* **Mother · Father**
ਭਰਾ · ਭੈਣ	*paraa · pain* **Brother · Sister**
ਹਾਂ · ਨਹੀਂ	*haan · naheen* **Yes · No**
ਮੈਂ ਪੰਜਾਬੀ ਸਿੱਖ ਰਿਹਾ ਹਾਂ!	*main panjaabee sikh rihaa haan!* **I am learning Punjabi! (a girl says: rahee haan)**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

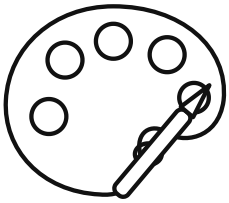
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), Eastern and Western Punjabi combined.

What's next?
You have met all **48 Punjabi letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Punjabi, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ਮਾਸ਼ਾਅੱਲਾਹ! ਸ਼ਾਬਾਸ਼!

maashaa-allaah! shaabaash! — Well done, bravo!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 48 letters of the Punjabi alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

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